

We've all heard of the wage gap, where women who are in the same field with the same experience are making less than their male colleagues. But very little attention is given to the wealth gap. When we aren't making enough and aren't investing enough, we see a much larger, much more damaging financial gap with cis white men on one side and, quite frankly, everyone else on the other.

You may have assumed that women and minorities just aren't good with money, or we just aren't smart enough to handle it. The truth is our relationship with money goes much deeper. Centuries deeper. Despite what our inner voice has been telling us, it has less to do with us and more to do with the way the world has worked, up until now.

You might THINK you're bad at money because you don't feel you're 'naturally good with numbers' but maybe it's a result of:

- institutional and structural barriers
- money media not representing us
- a culture of shame around discussing money.

Let me break it down.

## **Institutional and structural barriers**

A lot of us view our lack of financial literacy as a direct result of our own intelligence, much like I did in the past. I had the privilege of attending the best public schooling in my country, and yet the concepts of personal finance and investing were never introduced to us. The only financial education I had received up to that point was when representatives from a bank visited our school and handed out free piggy banks.

We're quick to blame ourselves for our lack of financial literacy and yet fail to recognise that we've had years of financial autonomy shaved off compared to our male counterparts. How can we compare our experience against that of people who have had a thousand-year head start? The financial industry was created for men, by men. The jargon, terminology and systems were, intentionally or not, created to serve people like themselves. Women weren't on the boards of directors when the modern